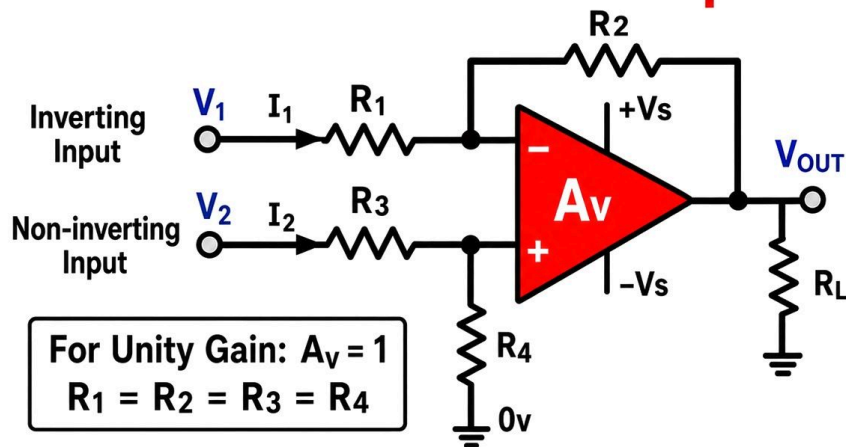




## The Basic Differential Amplifier



$$V_{OUT1} = V_1 \left( -\frac{R_2}{R_1} \right) \quad \text{and} \quad V_{OUT2} = V_2 \left( 1 + \frac{R_2}{R_1} \right) \left( \frac{R_4}{R_3 + R_4} \right)$$

$$V_{OUT} = V_{OUT1} + V_{OUT2} = V_1 \left( -\frac{R_2}{R_1} \right) + V_2 \left( 1 + \frac{R_2}{R_1} \right) \left( \frac{R_4}{R_3 + R_4} \right)$$

For :  $R_1 = R_3$  and  $R_2 = R_4$ , that is the ratio:  $\frac{R_3}{R_4} = \frac{R_1}{R_2}$

This reduces down too:  $V_{OUT} = \frac{R_2}{R_1} (V_2 - V_1)$



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A differential amplifier compares two input voltages and amplifies only the difference between them. In this circuit,  $V_1$  is applied to the inverting input through  $R_1$ , while  $V_2$  is applied to the non-inverting input through  $R_3$ . The op-amp adjusts its output so that both inputs stay at nearly the same voltage (virtual short condition).

The feedback resistor  $R_2$  controls how strongly the inverting input affects the output, while  $R_4$  forms a voltage divider with  $R_3$  for the non-inverting side. Because of this balanced structure, the circuit can reject signals that are common to both inputs, which is called common-mode rejection.

When resistor ratios are matched ( $R_1 = R_3$  and  $R_2 = R_4$ ), the circuit simplifies neatly. The output depends only on the difference between inputs:  $V_{out} = (R_2/R_1)(V_2 - V_1)$ . This makes it very useful in sensor measurements, noise reduction, and signal conditioning where small differences need to be amplified accurately.

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